

Action Verbs for Effective CVs

PRIME · Land it. Negotiate it. Own it.

Strong action verbs show you are results-driven, quantify your impact, and prove the value you delivered. Open every CV bullet with one — then back it with a number.

Leadership & people

Verb	In action
Led	Led the team that delivered the project under budget.
Managed	Managed a department of 15 sales professionals.
Trained / Coached	Trained new hires, accelerating their product knowledge.

Building & delivering

Verb	In action
Launched	Launched a new product line that generated £2M in revenue.
Created	Created a new system to optimise the workflow.
Established	Established strategic partnerships with 5 major clients.
Implemented	Implemented new HR policies that improved retention.

Results & improvement

Verb	In action
Increased / Decreased	Increased website traffic by 30%.
Reduced	Reduced production defects by introducing new QA processes.
Transformed	Transformed the customer service process, lifting satisfaction scores.
Achieved	Achieved top sales performer status three years in a row.

Commercial & analytical

Verb	In action
Negotiated	Negotiated contracts saving the company 15% on expenses.
Analysed	Analysed financial data and identified cost reductions.
Resolved	Resolved customer complaints and improved loyalty.

How to use them

- One verb, one bullet, one result — don't stack verbs in a single line.
- Vary your verbs across the CV; five bullets starting “Managed” reads flat.
- Match the verb to the job description's language where you honestly can.
- Quantify the outcome: money, percentages, time saved, people affected.